

CHAPTER-3

THE BLESSED SEERAH

حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ غَاثِمُ الثَّيْبِيْنَ صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ
(From the Treaty of Hudaibiyah to the Battle of Khyber)

Introduction

The word 'Seerat' literally means in Arabic: path and way. 'Seerat-e-Tayyiba' means the ways of the whole life of our beloved Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, which he adopted. Whether these adopted ways relate to worships, dealings, life style or to ethics. Whether they relate to his individual life, or relate to his collective life. Similarly, whether, these ways relate to his political life or to his administrative life. The whole life of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ is a beacon not only for the Muslims but also for all human beings. We can achieve success in this world and in the Hereafter only by studying and following the Seerah of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. The Holy Qur'an, has described his life as 'Uswa e Hasanah' i.e., the 'best example' for us.

We can achieve all the conveniences and blessings of religion and the world by studying and following the individual and collective life of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, because this is the only way for us.

Objectives

The given titles/lessons in this chapter i.e., Treaty of *Hudaibiyah*, Letters to world leaders and the Battle of *Khyber*, are to inform the students that reading and following the life of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ for us is a source of pride and mercy. Not only the study of his blessed life is necessary for us, but the practical demonstration on it also required. In other words we should adopt his *Seerat* too. After teaching them the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* and pledge of *Riz'wan*, they students should be urged to take care of the conditions while doing an agreement with the opposing party. Also, to study the letters sent by the Holy prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَأَصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ to the leaders of that time, and to inform them about the changes took place in result of them, at that time. Similarly, the students are made aware of the causes of the battle of *Khyber*, its events and results.

1-Treaty of Hudaibiyah

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Know the back ground and events of treaty of Hudaibiyah.
- Understand its terms and importance.
- Have benefits from the consequences of the treaty of Hudaibiyah in their practical lives.

Background

When the Holy Prophet ﷺ migrated from Makkah to Madinah, he settled there along with his companions and began to perform the great duty of preaching Islam there. The preaching was being continued and gradually Islam was started to spread over there. In the sixth year of *Hijrah* the Holy Prophet ﷺ told his companions رضى الله عنهم that he has seen in a dream that he along with the companions were performing Umrah in Makkah. It refers in the Holy Qur'an as Allah Almighty says:



لَقَدْ صَدَّقَ اللَّهُ رَسُولَهُ الْوَعْدَ بِالْحَقِّ لَنَنصُرَنَّكَ لَتَدْخُلَنَّ الْبَيْتَ الْأَشْرَفَ إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ آمَنُ لِلَّهِ مُخَلِّقِينَ رُءُوسَكُمْ وَمُقَصِّرِينَ لَا تَخَافُونَ فَعَلِمَ مَا لَمْ تَعْلَمُوا فَجَعَلَ مِنْ دُونِ ذَلِكَ فَتْحًا قَرِيبًا

Translation: Allah has indeed made the truthful dream of His Noble Messenger, come true; indeed you will all enter the Sacred Masjid, if Allah wills, in safety -with your heads shaven or hair cut short- without fear; so He knows what you do not know, and has therefore ordained another imminent victory before this. (Al-Fat'h: 27)

Knowing this, all the Companions started preparations for the pilgrimage to Holy Ka'ba. In 1st Dhul Qa'dah sixth of Hijrah, the Holy Prophet ﷺ accompanied by fourteen hundred Companions رضى الله عنهم, and left for Makkah. He appointed the famous Companion Hazrat Abdullah bin Umm -e- Maktoom as his deputy in Madinah.

Since the purpose of the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his Companions رضى الله عنهم was only to perform Umrah in Makkah, they did not have any military equipment with them, they had only the swords with them and they were also inside the sheath. In this journey Umm-ul-Mo'mineen Hazrat Umm-e-Salma رضى الله عنها was also with the Holy Prophet ﷺ. A place comes at a distance of about 5 km from Madinah, called 'Zul Hulaifah' of *Miqat* (i.e., The boundary lines which the pilgrims or those who want to perform 'Umra should not cross without adopting the Ihram) at this place, the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his Companions رضى الله عنهم intended for Umrah and had *ihram*.

Before leaving to Makkah, the Holy Prophet ﷺ sent *Bus'r bin Sufyan* a companion رضى الله عنه, to inquire about the conditions of the people of Makkah. When the Holy Prophet ﷺ reached at the place of 'Usfan', situated between Makkah and Madinah, Hazrat *Bus'r bin Sufyan* رضى الله عنه reported him that the Quraysh of Makkah were gathering outside Makkah with their chiefs and they will never allow the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his Companions رضى الله عنهم to perform *Um'rah*, and if they have to fight for it, they are also ready for it.

After raising this new situation, the Holy Prophet ﷺ consulted his Companions رضى الله عنهم. They suggested that the journey should be continued. Therefore, the Holy Prophet ﷺ and his Companions رضى الله عنهم continued their journey to Makkah. The Quraysh of Makkah tried to block the way of the Holy prophet ﷺ, but he left the well-known road and passed through the mountains and ravines and consequently reached the place of 'Hudaibiyah'. It is situated at about three miles away from Makkah.

Negotiation and dialogue for understanding

When the Holy Prophet ﷺ saw the bad intentions of the Quraysh, he sent a message to the Quraysh through Hazrat *Budail bin Warqa* رضى الله عنه that we have come here only with the intention to perform *Um'rah*, that's why we should be allowed to visit the Holy Ka'ba. But the Quraysh did not accept it. During this time negotiation was continued, but nothing was decided.

Then the Holy Prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat *Usman Ghani* رضى الله عنه as his special ambassador to settle the matter. He tried to understand the Quraysh of Makkah in every possible way that حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَّسُولُ اللَّهِ خَاتَمُ النَّبِيِّينَ ﷺ and we came only to perform *Um'rah*. After performing it, we will all go back to Madinah. The Quraysh only showed such flexibility to Hazrat *Usman* رضى الله عنه that if he wanted to perform *Umrah*, he could perform. But Hazrat *Usman* رضى الله عنه did not like to perform *Umrah* without the Holy Prophet ﷺ and other Companions رضى الله عنهم and turned down the offer of the Quraysh of Makkah.

When Hazrat *Usman* رضى الله عنه did not come for a time, a rumor broke out among the Muslims that Hazrat *Usman* رضى الله عنه had been martyred. The Muslims felt unrest and became very angry.

Pledge of Riz'wan:

The Holy Prophet ﷺ gathered the Companions رضى الله عنهم and said to them that 'We will not leave from here until we avenge the martyrdom of Hazrat *Usman*'. The Holy Prophet ﷺ sat down under the acacia tree and the Companions رضى الله عنهم came one by one and pledged to him. In *Surat-ul-Fath*, Allah mentions this incident in the following words:

لَقَدْ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنِ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ إِذْ يُبَايِعُونَكَ تَحْتَ الشَّجَرَةِ فَعَلِمَ مَا فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ فَأَنْزَلَ السَّكِينَةَ عَلَيْهِمْ وَأَثَابَهُمْ فَتْحًا قَرِيبًا

Translation: Indeed Allah was truly pleased with the believers when they swore allegiance to you beneath the tree - so He knew what was in their hearts - He therefore sent down peace upon them, and rewarded them with an imminent victory. (Al Fath, 18)

In the caliphate of Hazrat *Umar Farooq* رضى الله عنه, due to the fear of innovation (*Bid'aa*), this tree of acacia was cut off.

Treaty of Hudaibiyah and its conditions:

As soon as the *Kuffar* (non believers) of Makkah learnt of this pledge, they agreed to peace. The Quraysh sent *Shuhail bin Amr*, (who had not yet embraced Islam), to negotiate with the Muslims. After a lengthy discussion, they had an agreement between the Muslims and the Quraysh, which had far-reaching consequences for the rise of Islam. This agreement is known in the history of Islam as 'Treaty of *Hudaibiyah*'. Some of the conditions of it were as follows:

- This year Muslims will return to Madinah without performing Umrah. They will be allowed to enter Makkah next year but they will not stay for more than three days.
- Next year when the Muslims will come for Umrah, they will bring weapons with them but their swords, provided the swords will be well-sheathed.
- If any member of the Quraysh flees to Madinah as Muslim, so Muslims are bound to return him.
- If any Muslim who flees to Makkah from Madinah as non Muslim, so Quraysh will not return him to the Muslims.
- There will be no war between Quraysh and Muslims for next ten years.
- Besides Muslims and Quraysh, the other tribes of Arabia have the option to ally themselves to whichever party they wish. Whether they want to ally to Quraysh or to Muslims, they will be free in their decision.

Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه wrote the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* on behalf of the Muslims. The above mentioned conditions in the agreement were apparently against the Muslims except for a few of them, and the Muslims were not satisfied with them, but the Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم regarded this agreement in favor of the Muslims with his far-sighted vision given by Allah Almighty. Therefore, he also advised the companions to adhere strictly to this agreement.

The Clear victory:

Allah Almighty called this treaty a 'Clear victory' for the Muslims. Allah Almighty said in the Holy Qur'an:

إِنَّا فَتَحْنَا لَكَ فَتْحًا مُبِينًا

Translation: We have indeed bestowed on you a clear victory. (Al-Fath: 1)

Benefits of the treaty of Hudaibiyah

There were many benefits from this agreement for the Muslims, some of them are as follows:

1. The status of the Muslims was recognized.
2. The caravans of trade began to move freely.
3. During this period polytheists got an opportunity to understand the reality of Islam, because the Muslims treated them with sincerity, good deeds and high morals.
4. Due to this treaty, there was no fear of war from the people of Makkah, thus the Muslims got a good opportunity to preach Islam.
5. This treaty later led to the conquest of Makkah.

Summary of the Lesson

The treaty of *Hudaibiyah* took place in Dhul Qa'dah 6 A.H. The Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم, along with fourteen hundred Companions رضي الله عنهم left for Makkah with the intention of Umrah. The Quraysh of Makkah decided that they would not allow Muslims to enter Makkah for Umrah in any circumstances. The Holy prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم and his companions رضي الله عنهم stayed at the place of '*Hudaibiyah*' near Makkah. A series of negotiations began between the Muslims and the Quraysh. The Holy Prophet صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وأصحابه وسلم

appointed Hazrat Usman Ghani رضى الله عنه as his ambassador and sent him to Makkah for negotiation with the Quraysh. The rumor spread among the Muslims that Hazrat Usman رضى الله عنه had been martyred. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ under the acacia tree took a pledge from the Companions رضى الله عنهم that they would avenge the blood of Hazrat Uthman رضى الله عنه. This was called 'Pledge of Rizwan/ Bai'at e Rizwan'. When the *Kuffar* (non believers) of Makkah learnt of this pledge, they agreed to peace. The Quraysh sent *Shuhail* bin Amr, to negotiate with the Muslims. Hazrat Ali رضى الله عنه wrote this treaty on behalf of the Muslims. Few of its conditions were apparently against the Muslims and the Muslims were not satisfied with them, but the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ advised them to adhere strictly to it. This treaty was regarded a 'Clear victory' for the Muslims. This treaty later led to the conquest of Makkah and to the preaching of Islam.

The Companions رضى الله عنهم followed the instructions of حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ غَاثِمُ الْيَتِيْمِيْنَ صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and there were better consequences. Today our success depends on the obedience of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ. If we obey him completely, then we will be successful in this world and will have certain success in the Hereafter.

Activity for the students

Discuss the terms and benefits of the treaty of *Hudaibiyah*.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. What did the Holy Prophet dream of in the sixth year of Hijrah?
2. What was the real reason for pledge of Rizwan?
3. Write any two conditions, which were apparently against the Muslims?
4. Which agreement is declared 'clear victory' in the Holy Qur'an?
5. Write any two consequences of the treaty of *Hudaibiyah*.
6. Where did the Holy Prophet and the Companions intend to have Ihram for Um'rah?

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ sent this companion to inquire about the conditions of the people of Makkah:

(A) Hazrat Ali رضى الله عنه	(B) Hazrat Abu Bakr رضى الله عنه
(C) Hazrat Bus'r bin Sufyan رضى الله عنه	(D) Hazrat Zaid bin Haritha رضى الله عنه
2. The tree under which the Holy Prophet took a pledge from the Companions was:

(A) Palm tree	(B) Jujube tree
(C) Neem tree	(D) Acacia tree
3. The Holy Prophet was going to Makkah for:

(A) Trade	(B) Um'rah
(C) War	(D) Meeting the people of Makkah
4. The conditions of the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* were apparently against:

(A) The Quraysh	(B) The Muslims
(C) The Jews and Christians	(D) The Polytheists

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. *Hudaibiyah* is situated at about _____ miles away from Makkah.
2. A place comes near Madinah, is called _____.
3. According to the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* the Muslims and the Quraysh were bound not to start war for next _____ years.
4. The Holy Prophet ﷺ appointed _____ as his special ambassador and sent him for negotiation with the *Kuffar*.
5. This treaty has been regarded in the Holy Qur'an as *Fath-e-Mubeen*, which means _____.

4. Tick (✓) the correct sentences and (✗) the incorrect sentences:

Sentence	True	False
1. The conditions of the treaty of <i>Hudaibiyah</i> were against the Muslims.	☐	☐
2. The Holy Prophet ﷺ took pledge from the Companions under the acacia tree.	☐	☐
3. Hazrat Aysha رضي الله عنها was with the Holy Prophet ﷺ in the journey to <i>Hudaibiyah</i> .	☐	☐
4. Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه wrote the agreement of the treaty of <i>Hudaibiyah</i> on behalf of the Muslims.	☐	☐
5. The Holy prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat Umer رضي الله عنه as his ambassador for the purpose of peace.	☐	☐

5. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
1. The Holy prophet accompanied by fourteen hundred Companions,	as his ambassador for the purpose of peace.
2. The Holy prophet sent Hazrat Usman Ghani رضي الله عنه	Hazrat Ali wrote.
3. If any member of the Quraysh flees to Madinah as Muslim,	and left for Makkah in 1 st Dhul Qa'dah sixth of Hijrah.
4. On behalf of the Muslims the agreement of the treaty of <i>Hudaibiyah</i> .	so Muslims are bound to return him.

Instructions for the teachers

Instructions for Teachers:

Teachers should inform to the students more details of the treaty of *Hudaibiyah*.

2-Letters to the world Rulers

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Be aware of the purpose of the letters written by the Holy Prophet ﷺ to the rulers and will be able to interpret them.
- To mention the names of the rulers to whom the Holy Prophet ﷺ wrote letters, and to know among the rulers who accepted his invitation and who rejected it.
- Write down the names of rulers, who although did not believe in the Holy Prophet ﷺ in response to his letters, but by giving him regard they sent gifts to him.
- Write letters in their social lives for spreading the message of Islam in the light of *Seerat*.

Background

After the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* with the Quraysh of Makkah, when the Holy Prophet ﷺ returned to Madinah, he felt somewhat comfort by the Quraysh of Makkah. Then he decided to send the message of Islam to other countries and regions. For this purpose, he selected a few Companions رضي الله عنهم as his ambassadors, so that they could take the letters of the Holy Prophet ﷺ comprising invitation and preaching of Islam, to different kings. He started this in 6th Hijrah.

Some of the rulers are mentioned in the following, to whom the letters were sent:

1. Ruler of Abyssinia Negus:

His name was As'hamah bin Ab'jar. In the present modern world, Abyssinia is called 'Ethiopia'. It is an African country; the Christians lived there at that time. The ruler or king of Abyssinia was called '*Najashi*'/Negus. The Holy Prophet ﷺ dispatched Hazrat Amro bin Umayyah رضي الله عنه with his letter to the King of Abyssinia. In this blessed letter, the Holy Prophet ﷺ invited *Najashi* to Islam. When the king read the text of the letter, he stood up respectfully, kissed and placed it over his eyes. *Najashi* testified to the Oneness of Allah and the Prophethood of the Holy Prophet ﷺ. He embraced Islam and sent gifts along with the Muslims to Medina, who had been already there as refugees. On the demise of As'hamah the king *Najashi*, the Holy Prophet ﷺ was very sad.

2. Ruler of Bahrain:

Bahrain was a small state in the Arabian Peninsula, it was under Chosroe of Iran and there had been for a long time the rulers called '*Munazir*' (plural of *Munzir*). When the Holy Prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat Alaa bin Al-Hadrami رضي الله عنه with the blessed letter to the ruler of Bahrain, at that time *Munzir bin Sawa* was ruling there. Munzir bin Sawa read the

letter of the Holy Prophet ﷺ and was very much impressed. He embraced Islam at the same time and made his world and the hereafter better.

3. Ruler of Persia:

Present Iran is an ancient country; its old name was 'Persia'. Its ruler was called Chosroe. Persia had a great military power and was considered a world superpower at that time. When the Holy Prophet ﷺ started sending letters to the rulers, 'Chosroe Pervez' was ruling over Persia at that time.

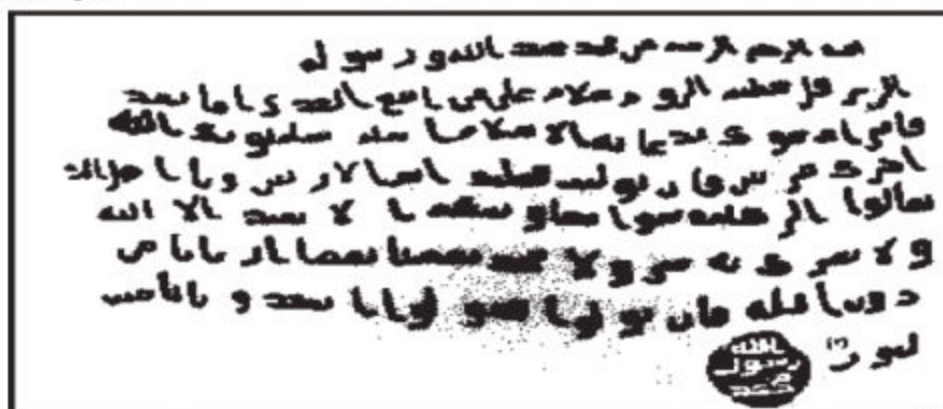
The Holy Prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat Abdullah bin Huzaafah رضى الله عنه with his blessed letter. When the letter was read to Chosroe Pervez, he tore the letter of the Holy Prophet ﷺ angrily and said: 'Being one of my subjects, he writes his name above my name and writes me like this.' When the Holy Prophet ﷺ came to know about this arrogance of the ruler of Persia (Iran), he said: 'Allah Almighty will tear his kingdom to pieces'. The words of the Holy Prophet ﷺ proved to be true word for word. On 10th of Jumaadal Ula 7th A.H his son Sherwayh revolted, killed his father and became the King of Persia. Later in the caliphate of Hazrat Umar رضى الله عنه, Persia (Iran) was conquered completely and was included in the Islamic Empire.

4. Ruler of Egypt Muqawqis:

The Holy Prophet ﷺ also sent a blessed letter of invitation to Islam to the ruler of Egypt *Muqawqis*, through Hazrat Haatib bin Abi Balta'ah رضى الله عنه. Muqawqis showed great esteem towards his blessed letter and wrote a polite reply also, but he did not accept Islam. He sent very valuable gifts to the Holy Prophet ﷺ, including a white mule, an Abyssinian slave and two maids, 'Maria' and 'Shireen'. These two were real sisters. One of these two, Bibi Maria Qibtiyyah رضى الله عنها was included in the Haram of the Holy Prophet ﷺ and was called 'Umm-ul-Mumineen' (Mother of the Believers). The son of the Holy Prophet ﷺ Hazrat Ibrahim عليه السلام was born from her. And Shireen came to the house of Hazrat Hassaan bin Saabit رضى الله عنه.

5. Ruler of Rome Caesar:

Rome is in Europe, like Persia (Iran), it was also a great country and superpower of that time. The Roman rulers were called 'Caesar'. At the time of the Holy Prophet ﷺ, Caesar of Rome was 'Hercules' (Hiraql). To convey the message of Islam to Hercules, the Holy Prophet ﷺ entrusted the duties of the embassy to Hazrat Dihyaa Al-Kalibi رضى الله عنه.



A picture of the blessed letter sent by the Holy Prophet ﷺ to Hercules the Caesar of Rome

In the name of Allah, the most Gracious and most Merciful.

From Muhammad, the slave and messenger of Allah, this letter is address to Hercules, the head of Rome. Peace be upon him who follows the divine guidance. I invite you to the call of Islam. Embrace Islam and you will be safe and Allah will reward you twofold. So if you turn down this invitation, the sin of the entire people of the country will be on your shoulders. 'O people of the scripture! Come to such a word that is the same between us and you, that we worship none but Allah and we do not associate partners unto Him and that none of us will take others as lords besides Allah. Then if they turn away, say: Bear witness that we are Muslims'.

Translation of current script of letter which was sent to Hercules the Caesar of Rome

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

مِنْ مُحَمَّدٍ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ وَرَسُولِهِ إِلَى هِرَقْلَ
عَظِيمِ الرُّومِ سَلَامٌ عَلَى مَنْ اتَّبَعَ الْهُدَى
أَمَّا بَعْدُ فَإِنِّي أَدْعُوكَ بِدَعَايَةِ الْإِسْلَامِ أَسْلِمْ
تَسْلِمًا يُؤْتِكَ اللَّهُ أَجْرَكَ مَرَّتَيْنِ فَإِن
تَوَلَّيْتَ فَإِنَّا عَلَيْكَ إِثْمُ الْأَرِيسِيِّينَ وَ
يَا أَهْلَ الْكِتَابِ تَعَالَوْا إِلَى كَلِمَةٍ سَوَاءٍ بَيْنَنَا
وَبَيْنَكُمْ أَلَّا نَعْبُدَ إِلَّا اللَّهَ وَلَا نُشْرِكَ بِهِ
شَيْئًا وَلَا يَتَّخِذَ بَعْضُنَا بَعْضًا أَرْبَابًا مِنْ دُونِ
اللَّهِ فَإِن تَوَلَّوْا فَقُولُوا اشْهَدُوا بِأَنَّا مُسْلِمُونَ

Current script of letter which was sent to Hercules the Caesar of Rome

Hazrat Dihyaa Al-Kalibi رضى الله عنه sent this blessed letter of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ to Hercules through the governor of Busra. When Hercules received the letter, he was in Jerusalem. He called Hazrat Abu Sufyaan رضى الله عنه the reality in the court and inquired about Islam and he also asked some questions there. Hercules ordered that if there is an Arab, he should be brought. Coincidentally, Hazrat Abu Sufyaan رضى الله عنه, (who had not yet embraced Islam), was there with a caravan of Quraysh on a business expedition. Hazrat Abu Sufyaan رضى الله عنه and his companions were brought in court of Hercules. Hercules asked him a few questions about Islam and the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. Hazrat Abu Sufyaan رضى الله عنه told exactly whatever the truth was, and praised the character of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ. Hercules replied, 'If whatever you say is really true, then he will soon take over my throne. If I ever happen to be in Arabia, I would wash his feet (in esteem).

Hercules left Hazrat Dihyaa Al-Kalibi رضى الله عنه by giving him great reverence and some gifts, but was depraved to embrace Islam for the fear of Christians and dispossessing of his kingship.

Besides this, the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ sent his blessed letter to Huzah bin Ali, the ruler of Yamaamah through Salit bin Amro Al-Amiri رضى الله عنه.

Summary of the Lesson

After the treaty of Hudaibiyah, our beloved Messenger of Allah صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ intended to spread the message of Islam to other countries. Some of the rulers, to whom the letters were sent, are: ruler of Abyssinia, ruler of Bahrain, ruler of Persia, ruler of Egypt and Caesar ruler of Rome. After reading the blessed letter of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ, Negus stood up respectfully, kissed the letter and embraced Islam. The ruler of Bahrain Munzir bin Sawa read the blessed letter, impressed very much and embraced Islam. The ruler of Egypt Muqawqis, showed great esteem to the blessed letter and sent valuable gifts to the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ, but was deprived of the blessing of belief. The ruler of Persia

tore the blessed letter. When the ruler of Rome Hercules, received the blessed letter, he asked Hazrat Abu Sufyaan رضى الله عنه a few questions about the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and Islam. He knew the truth of Islamic teachings but did not believe in it. To strive for the invitation of Islam through letters. From this we learned that in the light of the Seerat of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ for the invitation of Islam and for the propagation of the religion, we should sometimes invite others by words of mouth as well as letters, so that we may be successful in this world and in the Hereafter.



Picture of the seal of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, which he used to stamp on the letters sent to the different rulers for the invitation of Islam.

Activity for the students

Students should make a chart and write names of the rulers and the companions, who went to them with letters.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

- Write at least three names of the rulers, to whom the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ sent letters.
- What was the reaction of the ruler of Abyssinia on the letter of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ?
- What did Chosroe Pervez say in reply to the blessed letter of the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and what was his consequence?
- Who embraced Islam among the rulers by reading the blessed letters?
- What kind of gifts, the ruler of Egypt send to the Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ?

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. The writing of letters to the rulers was started:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| (A) in the end of 5 th A.H | (B) in the end of 6 th A.H |
| (C) in the end of 8 th A.H | (D) in the end of 9 th A.H |

2. Chosroe Pervez was killed by:

- | | |
|--------------|------------------|
| (A) his wife | (B) his minister |
| (C) his son | (D) his brother |

3. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ sent in the court of Abyssinia ruler:

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Hazrat Dihyaa Al-Kalibi رضى الله عنه | (B) Hazrat Alaa bin Al-Hadrami رضى الله عنه |
| (C) Hazrat Amro bin Umayyah رضى الله عنه | (D) Hazrat Haatib bin Abi Balta'ah رضى الله عنه |

4. Hercules was the ruler of:

- (A) Egypt (B) Persia
(C) Rome (D) Iraq

5. Hazrat Amr bin Umayyah رضى الله عنه was sent with the letter to:

- (A) ruler of Bahrain (B) ruler of Egypt
(C) ruler of Persia (D) ruler of Abyssinia

3. Fill in the blanks:

1. The ruler or king of Abyssinia is called _____.
2. Bahrain was a small state in the _____.
3. The ruler of Persia was called _____.
4. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ sent a blessed letter to *Muqawqis*, through _____.
5. The rulers of Rome were called at that time _____.

4. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
1. The ruler of Abyssinia is called	Persia.
2. The ancient name of Iran was	killed.
3. Chosroe Pervez was	Negus/Najashi.
4. The present name of Abyssinia is	the ruler of Bahrain.
5. <i>Munzir bin Sawa</i> was	Ethiopia.

Instructions for the teachers

- Find out the countries in the map, to whose rulers the Holy Prophet sent letters, and explain to students.
- Respected teachers make students write the letters for the preaching of Islam.

3-Battle of Khyber

Learning Outcomes

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

- Explain the background of the battle of Khyber.
- Know the events and results of the battle of Khyber.
- Explain the details of the bravery of Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه and the conquest of Khyber.
- Learn the lessons from the events of the battle of Khyber in the light of *Seerat*, and try for the raise of Islam.

Village of Khyber



Background

The town of Khyber was situated about 125 miles (200 km) at north of Madinah. It was a very fertile area. Most of the land consisted of oasis. The Jews inhabited in this town. They were always busy in anti-Islamic activities and conspiracies. They did not miss any opportunity to weaken and harm Islam.

Hostility of Jews and Banu Ghatfaan tribe to Islam:

Banu Nuzair, a Jewish tribe, used to live in Medina. They used to conspire against Islam. When the Holy Prophet ﷺ expelled Banu Nuzair from Madinah due to their anti-Islamic activities, this tribe also went to Khyber, took refuge therein and made it their center.

Another tribe, Banu Ghatfaan, also lived near Khyber. This tribe also tried to be at the front of anti-Islamic activities. It also became an ally of the Jews in hostility to Islam. All these tribes united against Islam and started conspiracies against it. They had strong fortifications, many military equipment and abundant food provisions. When the Holy Prophet ﷺ came to know about these intentions of the Jews, he sent his renowned companion Hazrat Abdullah bin Rawaha to Khyber for investigating secretly. Hazrat Abdullah bin Rawaha collected information with utmost secrecy and confirmed the conspiracies.

Events:

The Holy Prophet's ﷺ departure for Khyber:

When the Holy Prophet ﷺ was convinced of the conspiracies of the Jews, he decided to put an end to them. When he returned to Madinah after making the treaty of *Hudaibiyah*, he stayed the whole month of Dhu al-Hijjah and a few days of Muharram in 7th A.H and just after that he declared Jihad against the people of Khyber and also said that those Companions, who were with me in the treaty of *Hudaibiyah* will participate in this Jihad. Therefore, the Holy Prophet ﷺ left for Khyber in 7th A.H. There were 200 infantries and 200 riders. The Companions رضي الله عنهم who migrated to Abyssinia during the Makki period, they also participated in this battle. Umm-ul-Mu'minin Hazrat Umm-e-Salma رضي الله عنها and many other female companions رضي الله عنهن also took part in this battle.

The chief of the hypocrites, Abdullah bin Abui bin Salul, informed the Jews through his spies that حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ ﷺ was coming to fight you. Neither do they have a high number, nor they have more weapons, so crush them and destroy them.

Strategy of the Holy Prophet ﷺ:

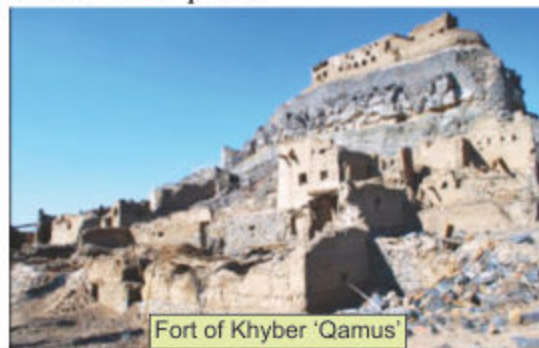
The Holy Prophet ﷺ with his army left Madinah and reached the place, where the tribes of Banu Ghatfaan were living. He adopted a new strategy and went a little further in the 'valley of Raji' and encamped therein. From the military point of view, this area was situated between Banu Ghatfaan and Khyber. So the Holy Prophet ﷺ blocked the way of further aid for the Jews. However ten thousands people of Banu Ghatfaan were ready to help the Jews.

Attack of Khyber:

The Islamic Army reached Khyber at night, when the people of Khyber were sleeping soundly. When they woke up in next morning and were going out to their fields, they suddenly saw the Islamic army around them and ran away towards the city and shouted that حضرت مُحَمَّدٌ رَسُوْلُ اللهِ ﷺ had arrived with his army. They ran and hid in their fortresses. The Jews had eight forts; one of them was called 'Na'im', in which the Jews stored supplies. The Muslims first attacked this fort. With the help of Allah Almighty, the fort Na'im was easily conquered and after which some other small and big forts were conquered.

Courage of Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه:

The strongest and largest Fortress of the Jews was 'Qamus', there brave and courageous warriors of the Jews and their great leaders were present. The Muslims attacked this fort many times, but could not get success. The famous Jewish warrior 'Marhab' was in charge of guarding the fort. The Holy Prophet ﷺ said: 'Tomorrow I will hand over this



flag to a person who loves Allah and His Messenger ﷺ and Allah and His Messenger ﷺ also love him.' In the next morning, the Companions رضي الله عنهم came to the Holy Prophet ﷺ. Everyone wanted to be given the flag. The Holy Prophet ﷺ summoned Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه. At that time, Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه was suffering from an infection of the eyes. The Holy Prophet ﷺ

applied his blessed saliva on the eyes of Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه and without delay the eyes of Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه were healed. The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ handed over the flag to Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه and sent him to meet Marhab. According to the Islamic tradition, Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه first invited Marhab to Islam, but he rejected it with great arrogance and proceeded to recite this poem:

قَدْ عَلِمْتُ خَيْرُ أَيِّ مَرْحَبٍ شَاكِيَ السِّلَاحِ بَطْلٌ مُجَرَّبٌ
إِذَا اللَّيُوثُ أَقْبَلَتْ تَلَهَّبُ

‘The citizens of Khyber are well aware that I am Marhab, armed, brave and experienced of war.
When the lions come, they roar’.

Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه came to meet Marhab and responded with this poetry:

أَنَا الَّذِي سَمَّيْنِي أُمِّي حَيْدَرَهُ كَلَيْتُ غَابَاتٍ كَرِيهِ الْمَنْظَرَهُ
أَوْفِيهِمْ بِالصَّاعِ كَيْلَ السَّنْدَرَهُ

‘I am the one whose mother named me Haider (the lion). Terrible as the lion of the forest, I give my opponents the measure of sandara in exchange for sa'a (goblet).’

Then Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه struck Marhab with a sword on his head so hardly, that he piled up there. As soon as he was killed, the Jews lost their morale, yet they were still locked up in various forts and struggled to fight with the Muslims. But the Muslims did not allow them to stop anywhere.

The Holy Prophet صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ also laid siege to the area called ‘Katiba’. After 14 days of siege, the enemy became helpless and surrendered.

Results:

- These results of the battle of Khyber were as follows:
- The Jews left their gardens, land and all their property and left Khyber along with their children.
- The Muslims got a lot of booty.
- When the booty was distributed among the Companions, they became wealthier.
- The Jews requested the Holy Prophet to let us live in our lands; we will look after the land, the gardens and the fields. The Holy Prophet accepted their request and ordered that half of the produce of the fields and fruits would be given to the Jews.
- 93 Jews were killed in the battle of Khyber, while a few Muslims were martyred. In this battle, the Muslims got a lot of booty, half of which was distributed equally among the soldiers and half of it was deposited in the public treasury.
- After the battle of Khyber, Islam began to spread more rapidly in the world and people began to enter into the circle of Islam in groups.

We learn from the conquest of Khyber that revolting against Allah Almighty and His Messenger صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ and engaging in conspiracies against them, lead to disgrace and humiliation not only in this world but also in the Hereafter; because the honor and the power are only for Almighty Allah and His Messenger صَلَّى اللهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَاصْحَابِهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

Summary of the Lesson

The town of Khyber was situated about 200 km at north of Madinah. The Jews inhabited in this town. They were always busy in anti-Islamic activities and conspiracies. Ghatfaan tribe was located near Madinah. This tribe also tried to be at the front of anti-Islamic activities. The Jews of Khyber had strong fortifications, many military equipment and abundant food provisions. The Holy Prophet ﷺ after coming to know about the intentions of the Jews, sent his renowned companion Hazrat Abdullah bin Rawaha رضى الله عنه to Khyber for investigating secretly. After a few days of the treaty of *Hudaibiyah*, the Holy Prophet ﷺ declared Jihad against the people of Khyber. The Holy Prophet ﷺ along with his companions رضى الله عنهم left for Khyber in 7th A.H. The Jews had eight forts; the Muslims attacked first on the fort 'Na'im', and which was easily conquered. After which some other small and big forts were conquered. The largest Fortress of the Jews was 'Qamus'. It was not conquered with ease. The Holy Prophet ﷺ sent Hazrat Ali رضى الله عنه there for fight. Hazrat Ali رضى الله عنه met the warrior of the Jews Marhab and killed him. With the death of Marhab this fort was also conquered. 93 Jews were killed in the battle of Khyber, while a few Muslims were martyred.

Therefore, we should always strive to obey to Allah Almighty and His Messenger ﷺ, to strive for the highness of Islam and to please Him and His messenger ﷺ, so that we could be prosperous in this world and in the Hereafter.

Activity for the students

Write the poetry in your note books, that Hazrat Ali recited in front of Marhab in the battle of Khyber.

Exercise

1. Answer the following questions:

1. Why did the tribe Banu Nuzair make Khyber their center?
2. Why did the Holy Prophet ﷺ announce Jihad against the Jews of Khyber?
3. Which was the strongest and largest Fortress of the Jews?
4. What poetry was recited in exchange between Hazrat Ali رضى الله عنه and Marhab?
5. What lesson do we learn from the Battle of Khyber?

2. Tick ✓ on the right answer:

1. Khyber was situated at north of Madinah about:
(A) 200 km (B) 300 km
(C) 400 km (D) 500 km
2. The valley in which the Holy Prophet ﷺ encamped, was called:
(A) valley of Ta'if (B) valley of Raji
(C) valley of Bat'haa (D) valley of Usfaan

3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ stayed at Madinah after the treaty of Hudaibiyah for:

- (A) 10 days (B) 12 days
(C) 15 days (D) the month of Dhul Hijjah and few days of Muharram

4. Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه was suffering from an infection of the eyes in the battle of Khyber, the Holy Prophet ﷺ applied on his eyes:

- (A) water (B) blessed saliva
(C) the honey (D) Kohl

3. Fill in the blanks:

- The fort of _____ was attacked first in the battle of Khyber and conquered.
- The Holy Prophet ﷺ left to the battle of Khyber in Muharram _____.
- The Jews had _____ forts.
- Abdullah bin Ubai was called _____.
- Another tribe _____ also lived near Khyber.

4. Tick (✓) the correct sentences and (✗) the incorrect sentences:

Sentence	True	False
1. The Jews of Khyber were always busy in anti-Islamic activities and conspiracies.	☐	☐
2. Tribe Banu Ghatfaan was the ally of the Muslims.	☐	☐
3. The Holy Prophet ﷺ with his companions announced Jihad against the people of Khyber.	☐	☐
4. Hazrat Ali رضي الله عنه killed Marhab in the battle of Khyber.	☐	☐
5. 93 Muslims were martyred in the battle of Khyber.	☐	☐

5. Match the words of column A with the words of column B:

Column A	Column B
1. Near Khyber, also lived another tribe	93 Jews were killed.
2. The Jews' strongest and	Banu Ghatfaan.
3. The Holy Prophet also laid siege to 'Katiba'	Marhab and killed him.
4. In the Battle of Khyber.	largest Fortress was Qamus.
5. Hazrat Ali met the Jewish warrior	the area.

Instructions for the teachers

Explain to students the conquest of the fort Qamus in detail.